If Things Were Different

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/58662718.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Scorpia (She-Ra), Sea Hawk (She-Ra), Entrapta (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Tooth-Rotting Fluff, Mild Hurt/Comfort, Season 2, Adora is in Love with Catra (She-Ra), Catra is in Love with Adora (She-Ra), One-Sided Catra/Scorpia (She-Ra), Drunk Adora (She-Ra), Disk Drunk | Infected Adora (She-Ra), Episode: s02e05 White Out (She-Ra), Canon Divergence, Useless Lesbians, Scorpia is a Good Friend (She-Ra)

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If Things Were Different

by Lyssandia

Summary

Sure, she wanted Adora back, wanted to use She-Ra against the Rebellion, but… was this really the Adora she wanted?

Notes

Yes, another short one!
After a certain life-stream and some prompt on twitter, I just had to write this!
Took me a bit longer than anticipated, but I got it done eventually!

Big thanks to CanadianBear for beta-reading and making great suggestions!

Maybe this was a bad idea after all.

Catra thought it would be so easy to control She-Ra after infecting the sword with this virus, but she now had to admit that this maybe wasn't the case.

She had the infected sword, but she needed to find a way to control She-Ra with it if she wanted to use Adora for the Horde against the Rebels.

Without Scorpia, I'd probably be dead by now.

Shivering, she tried to think of another plan as she she left the room to check the alarm, not even looking back to Scorpia and the unconscious Adora, not wanting to show her insecurity about this.

The rage and bloodlust in She-Ra's furious movements had surprised her, she never thought her former best friend would ever try to actually kill her.

Hissing, Catra shook her head in an attempt to forget the sheer hate in those red-veined eyes when the infected She-Ra swung her sword mercilessly at her.

Did… Adora really hate her now?

The thought hurt more than Catra wanted to admit, a big lump forming in her stomach.

She never thought Adora would actually hate her, but then again, after everything that had happened between them in that freaky ruin, how could she not? But it was fine, Adora had made her choice when she left.

Just, why did that thought hurt so much then?
Deep down, she knew she didn't want Adora to hate her. She still wanted her best friend back! Wanted them to be as before! But apparently, that was too much to ask.

Catra was glad no one could see her right now when she swiped away some cold sweat from her brows, her hands still shaking at the thought of She-Ra swinging that sword at her without hesitation.

“Why is this damn place so fucking cold?”

She tried to tell herself that her shivering was only because she's felt cold since they arrived here.

The Fright Zone wasn’t a great place, but it was at least way better than this freezing hell!

She shook her head, cutting off any more of those rambling thoughts. She needed to check on what set off the alarm.

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Scorpia looked at Adora with a frown.

What was wrong with the former Horde soldier?

Adora acted like an idiot and Scorpia wasn't sure what to do with her when she danced through the room with a mop in her hands talking nonsense.

Was this seriously the girl Catra missed so much?

Not that Catra would ever admit that, and certainly not to Scorpia, but it was obvious anyway.

Scorpia sighed and tried to do what Catra told her to do and shove this nasty feeling away that she had whenever she looked at Adora.

But it was hard.

She had just saved Catra's life and she was sure the Force Captain was grateful for that, but Catra barely ever acknowledged her, nor did she look at her the same way she looked at Adora.

Never.

She wanted to spend more time with Catra so badly, have a date and… but every time she brought something up, the feline just brushed it off.

Would she brush off Adora in the same way?

That thought left a sting in her heart and Scorpia's mood went down.

“Ugh, okay, let’s go back to Entrapta!” She grabbed Adora’s arm and shoved her to the door, wondering again what the code Catra had put in was.

“Boop, boop, beep, boob!” Adora was having great fun typing on the keypad, despite Scorpia's attempts to stop her.

“What are you doing? Stop that!”

“I just used Catra’s favorite number!” Adora stated with a goofy grin and Scorpia grunted.

Did she have to rub it in that she knew so much more about Catra than Scorpia did?

This wasn’t exactly the best day Scorpia ever had.

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“Shit!”

Catra hated this place!

She had found out *what* exactly had set off the alarm and she wasn’t fond of it at all.

Why did those two big bugs have to appear right now?

They seemed to be enraged and she heard them screeching loudly behind her when she ran away from them as fast as she could.

She wasn’t in favor of fighting those two huge things without any help. The Force Captain wasn’t stupid, she knew when an enemy was too big for her.

It wasn’t easy to escape them without giving away her location, but she eventually managed, reaching the part of base where she had left the others earlier.

Maybe it helped that the other rebellion idiots made enough noise to lure the creatures into their direction instead of hers.

Panting, she entered the base, heading towards the voices she heard.

“Scorpia, I need y…. what are you doing?”

She couldn’t believe her eyes!

Scorpia was actually talking to one of those guys from the Rebellion! The annoying one with the mustache of all people!

“Catra! Did you find out…” Scorpia couldn't finish her sentence, because someone else's voice screamed in elated anticipation.

“CATRA!”

Catra’s eyes became as big as saucers and her tail poofed up when Adora suddenly wrapped herself tightly around her, laughing.

“I missed you so much, Catra!”

“Adora… what…?” The feline tried to loosen Adora’s grip, but it was almost impossible.

“You're my best friend!” Adora rumbled on, hugging Catra even tighter. “But we're enemies right now, aren’t we?”

Suddenly, Adora’s face scrunched and she started to cry bitterly, like she had done a few times as a child.

“What’s wrong with you?” Catra demanded, completely confused by this behavior, but Adora didn’t seem to hear her.

“She's nuts! She's been like that since she woke up,” Scorpia explained.

“Does this have to do with the disk?” Catra wondered, still trying to get Adora off her - a futile attempt, since Adora just gripped her even tighter.

“I don't want to be your enemy!” Adora cried on, watching Catra. Her gaze became a different one again as she lightly touched Catra’s cheek. “You're so pretty, kitty.”

Wait what?

Catra’s cheeks turned red in an instant. Why would Adora say something like that?

“Don't touch me!” she tried again, but Adora held her fast and suddenly began giving her ear some scritches in the way she had always loved them.

“Don't….,” Catra repeated, but it was too late. Her purr already came forth, her face flushing in embarrassment.

Adora knew her just too well. She couldn’t resist this.

“I’m still your friend, aren’t I?” Adora’s voice asked innocently near her ear and Catra could only nod, the scritches making her too soft.

“Hooray!” Adora cheered, hugging Catra tightly again, stopping the scritches.

The feline's purr continued, but she was so, so confused.

What the fuck was happening? Was this a new tactic to get Catra to let her guard down so the blond could get the upper hand?

But Adora seemed so genuine in her innocent playful nature right now and the hug felt so good. So right. Catra hadn’t had such a hug in forever and the warmth she got from it spread through her body rapidly, chasing the cold that had sunk into her body away.

She wanted to keep being held like this! She didn't want Adora to let her go.

“Is this a trick?” Catra asked with a hoarse voice, her arms twitching, not sure if she could, or should, hug Adora back.

Adora laughed frantically and let go, but immediately, Catra brought up her arms and grabbed on tightly herself.

“Don't let go!” She whined, in contrary to her former demand. “Don't tease me like that. Stop hurting me!” She whispered, only for Adora to hear.

“I would never hurt you!” Adora insisted, hugging even tighter now. “I love you so much!”

Catra’s eyes widened, shocked at hearing the words she had wanted to hear for so long, a single tear rolling down her cheek.

Was it true?

Did Adora really love her?

She wanted to believe this so bad.

For a second, she melted into Adora’s embrace, allowing herself to be soft, forgetting that they weren’t the only people in the room.

“Is this a dream?” Surely it couldn’t be true?

Was this goofy doofus serious about what she was saying?

Was this a result of this weird infection?

Catra became very aware of the disk in her pocket, not sure what she should do now.

“Naaah, you’re awake, dummy,” Adora giggled, patting on Catra’s back.

“Who are you calling a dummy, you idiot?” Catra barked back, but the curve of her lips gave away her amusement.

It all felt so familiar.

They loosened the hug and Catra wasn’t sure what to do now.

Sure, she wanted Adora back, wanted to use She-Ra against the Rebellion, but… was this really the Adora she wanted? This silly blabbering mess, that seemed to be drunk?

Adora looked at her with half-lidded eyes, smiling from one ear to another. This wasn’t a look Catra had ever seen on her.

The weight of the disk, still hidden inside her pocket, grew even more apparent.

She suddenly felt Adora’s finger poking her chest, her brows frowning. “Say it,” she demanded, poking Catra with her finger once more. “Say it back!”

“What?” Catra asked, even more confused.

“Say that you love me! You do, don’t you? I want you to hear you say it…” Adora’s expression changed from demanding to insecurity and the sadness that suddenly was in her eyes was almost too much to bear for Catra.

“I…,” she began, but she couldn't actually say it. Though her face flushed into a deep red and her heart pounded like crazy in her chest.

Adora moved fast. So fast Catra couldn’t do anything about it, and she felt Adora’s lips on her own and just melted away.

The kiss was everything she had always imagined, always wanted. Soft. Giddy. Intimate. Pure Adora.

Catra purred into it and let go of all doubts for the moment as she kissed Adora back. This was just too good to give up on.

She didn't even recognize the sound of the door opening and closing again.

The taste of Adora’s tongue was much more important than anything else around her.

Her hand reached into her pocket without thinking. She just wanted this to be true. If Adora really loved her, it would change everything! But Catra needed to know. Needed to be certain that this was really what Adora felt for her, and not just a stupid side effect of this damn disk infection!

Catra’s hand closed around the disk and she didn't care that it might cut her, she just crushed it.

The effect was immediate.

Adora stilled, blinking, wondering what was going on, that weird fog in her head lifted, taking a moment to realize what was happening.

Why the hell was she kissing Catra?

Not that it felt bad, on the contrary, but what was going on?

Oh. Right. She had told the feline she loved her… hadn’t she?

She had no idea why she did that, but it felt good. Like the right thing to do.

She moved back a bit, looking into Catra’s anticipating, flushed face.

Stars, she was so beautiful!

Catra had always been pretty, but to see her like that was making butterflies fly in her stomach.

“Catra…,” she whispered, and hearing the other girl's purr filled her chest with affection, and she couldn’t help herself cupping Catra’s face with her hand.

She didn't think Catra would lean into it like that, blushing even more.

Adora had no idea what exactly had happened, but she understood that this situation was delicate. Was it an opportunity to end the quarrel with her former best friend?

It was now or never. But before she could say anything, Catra did.

"I love you… I… I always have…," the feline whispered her own confession as she shifted her gaze to the floor, not able to keep looking Adora in the eyes. There was a sadness in her face, almost as if she expected to be turned down, ready to sob.

It was Adora's turn to blush, her cheeks a deep red now, but a small smile formed on her lips. This was the Catra she knew. The girl she grew up with, not the fierce Force Captain that wanted to win the war so badly.

Was this her chance to win Catra over?

Adora feared Catra might back off any minute if she said the wrong thing.

Trying to convince her that her way was wrong, that the Horde did wrong didn't do the trick earlier. It wouldn't do the trick now.

She couldn't screw this opportunity up again!

She had to try something else. She briefly looked over to Glimmer and Bow, who had entered the room but not dared to move or say anything ever since, too flabbergasted by seeing her and Catra kiss, and considered her next words, knowing they could change everything.

She braced herself.

"Catra, I… I want to be with you all the time. I miss you so, *so* much. I can't stop thinking about you and how much I want you by my side."

Catra listened closely, her heart hammering hard in her chest at those words. She didn't dare say anything yet and kept her gaze on the floor.

"I know I hurt you, but I never wanted to leave *you* . Just because I don't want to serve the Horde anymore doesn't mean I don't want to be with you," Adora continued.

She could easily see how Catra pondered, not sure what to do next, biting her lips.

Risking it all, Adora put her hands carefully on Catra's face, gently forcing her to look at her again. The feline didn't resist at all, her face still flushed, her mismatched eyes watery.

“I want you. I'd love it if you'd join me, but… I know you probably don’t want that. And I can’t make you. But I don't want to fight you, I don’t want to hurt you. I never wanted that. All I want is to love you until the day I die!”

There, she said it all.

Never before had Adora dared to say what she wished for, had tried to express her feelings like that.

But she knew she had to do this if she ever wanted Catra to reconsider her decisions, to have her in her life again.

Catra stared at her wide-eyed, not sure if she could believe her ears, her face still held by the blonde. “You… really mean that…?”

Instead of saying more, Adora kissed her again, banishing all doubts.

She knew this was the only way to convince Catra that she really meant it.

The feline was surprised to be kissed again, but it melted all the cold away, heat igniting in Catra’s whole heart and core as she kissed Adora back wistfully.

Suddenly the door opened again, letting in a chilling breeze.

“Hey Catra, those beasts we saw earlier vanished and we…” Entrapta chirped in her usual excited way, but her expression turning baffled witnessing Adora and Catra letting go of each other hastily with very red faces.

“Am I interrupting something?”

The magical moment was broken and all of them stared at each other incredulously.

“Ahem, I guess our work here is… finished… then? Do we return to the Fright Zone now?” Scorpia tried, not sure what else to say.

“Yeah, uhm, Adora, maybe… just… let’s go home?” Glimmer suggested, still not sure if she was experiencing a nightmare right there or not. Seeing Adora and their enemy Catra like that wasn’t something she had anticipated.

Adora still stared at Catra who was standing in front of her with her tail fully puffed out and thrashing, one hand clutching the other arm, looking at the floor again.

“It's your choice,” she said. “Catra, if you wanna come with me, be with me… I’m… I’m here for you, okay? You don’t have to join the Rebellion, but… I still want you.”

Entrapta ticked Bow's shoulder with her hair. “Care to explain what's going on here?” She asked, trying to whisper, but still loud enough for everyone to hear.

“I… I think they both confessed their love to each other? I have no idea what's going on…” He answered, but still found himself anticipating Catra's answer to Adora’s offer.

“Scorpia, Entrapta, let’s go. We’re leaving!" Catra ordered after clearing her throat, apparently not able to give Adora a proper answer.

As much as she wanted to bury herself into Adora’s embrace, she suddenly wasn’t sure anymore if she could afford it.

“You… sure?” Scorpia asked hesitantly, but one sharp glance from Catra got her moving.

“Okay, okay, you’re the boss!”

Catra turned to go with them, not sure if she could stand to look at Adora again.

“You can’t go just like that!” Glimmer interrupted her leave though, teleporting in her way. “You owe Adora an answer!”

She was taken aback when she looked in Catra’s face, the various emotions flickering there surprising her as much as the tears she saw. She had taken Catra for a cold-hearted bitch, not for an emotional lesbian disaster.

Glimmer's action stopped Catra’s track and with a hiss her tail thrashed loudly in the air.

“I'll think about it, okay? Now out of my way! We're done here!”

Her voice broke more than she liked, giving away how much this situation had confused her.

“Let her go, Glimmer,” Adora pleaded to her friend.

With a stern expression on her face, Glimmer let Catra pass, who vanished fast.

-

“I can’t believe you’re in love with her!” Glimmer whined later, on their way back on Sea Hawk’s newest ship, the Dragon’s Daughter II.

“Glimmer! Don’t call her out on that!” Bow protested, but Adora waved him off.

“It's okay… I mean… ugh… it’s weird. And complicated. You only know her as our enemy, but…”

Bow interrupted her, putting his hand on her shoulder. “But you grew up with her. You know her very differently than we do.”

Adora nodded, grateful he understood and supported her.

“She's not evil! Catra's actually very kind and sensitive and she always knows how to cheer me up. She can be rough and wild and brusk, but she's never been a bad person!”

Glimmer scoffed, but seeing that Adora was serious, she swallowed her words.

She didn't want to hurt Adora’s feelings intentionally. Instead, she sighed, asking. “Since when did you know that you were in love with her? And why didn't you tell us?”

“I don't know, to be honest. I think I kinda… always… loved… her. And I never told you, because I didn't think we could be together after I left the Horde. She suddenly was my enemy, and who knows if she still is…”

Adora sobbed, receiving a comforting, crushing hug from Bow.

“It's not too late for both of you,” he said calmly.

“I hope so! But…. if she really leaves the Horde for me… if she’s ever becoming my partner, would you even accept her?”

“We would,” Glimmer answered.

She hated the catgirl with all she’s got, but when she thought back to Catra’s face and all the overwhelming emotions she caught a glimpse of, she knew the other girl reciprocated Adora’s feelings. Glimmer just hoped that she made the right decision.

Glimmer realized she wanted Adora to be happy and if that meant she'd have to accept Catra in her life, so be it. Maybe Catra would even be tolerable.

Adora gave Glimmer a thankful smile, glad to hear that.

She finally had some hope.

Hope that maybe even She-Ra deserved a bit of happiness.

-

Scorpia felt sad, but also relieved.

She finally had some clarity, and even though it hurt to know that her object of desire would never feel the same for her, that didn’t mean they wouldn’t be friends.

She looked at the small, shivering mess that was Catra, who tried to find some warmth under that thin blanket she found while the cold airstream from the skiff surrounded her, and went to join her.

To her surprise, Catra offered her some space under the blanket, which the scorpion lady happily took.

Catra looked like she was deep in thought, probably considering all her options now.

Scorpia wasn’t sure why Catra was still this hesitant. For her, it was all very clear.

“You should take her offer,” Scorpia said.

Catra flinched, feeling caught. “Why?”

Scorpia chuckled. “You love her. Why wouldn’t you want to be with the one you love if she loves you back?”

Catra turned deep red and buried her face in her hands. “It's not that easy!”

“Yes it is!” Scorpia claimed. “We can leave the Horde.”

“We?”

“Hah, of course. Do you think I’d leave you alone? If you decide to leave the Horde, I'll be with you.” Scorpia winked at Catra.

Catra looked at her dumbfoundedly, as if she had never expected this. Then her gaze turned apologetic.

“I'm sorry I can’t reciprocate your feelings. You're a good friend, but…”

“...but your heart belongs to Adora. I know.”

Scorpia sighed, smiling at Catra melancholically. It was the first time Catra acknowledged that she had noticed.

To be turned down hurt a bit, but it was a lot better than hoping for something that would never come.

“And you'd still leave the Horde with me?” Catra asked, not quite convinced yet.

She wanted to take Adora’s offer so bad, but could she just leave everything behind she knew? Wasn’t the devil she knew better than the unknown?

“If you want to leave, yes.” Scorpia confirmed.

Catra fell silent, clearly pondering, touching her lips absent-mindedly.

“What good has the Horde ever done for you?” Scorpia asked after a while.

That’s when she noticed a change in Catra, who took a moment to think a bit more.

“Nothing.” She finally answered. “The Horde has never done anything for me.”

“Have you ever been happy there?” Scorpia knew the answer to that, but she also realized that for Catra to believe it, she needed to come to the same conclusion herself.

“No. I… the only thing, only one, who ever made me happy was… Adora…”

Scorpia didn't say anything to that, but gave Catra an anticipating look.

“Ugh, fine! I guess we're doing this then.”

Catra shrugged, not sure if she made the right decision. But she realized she didn't have anything to lose, but a lot to win.

“Entrapta?” She called the one driving the skiff.

“Yes?”

“Change of plans! Set course to Bright Moon!”

End~

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!